1 Catalyst Project Close-out Report March 2026

1.1 **Project ID**: 1300148

Project Name: Onboard Tertiary IT Students targeting 16 universities Globally

Fund: 100 000 ADA

Link: https://projectcatalyst.io/funds/13/cardano-open-ecosystem/onboard-tertiary-it-students-targeting-16-universities-globally

1.2 **Name of Project Manager**: Bernard Sibanda(CTO – Coxygen Global)

1.3 **Date project started:** March 2025

1.4 **Date project completed:** March 2026

2 Challenge KPIs: How We Addressed them

2.1 Many universities/colleges students do not know Cardano

This project introduced Cardano directly to tertiary students through on-chain credentials and certification via our partner, EBU Luxembourg.

2.2 Partnerships between tertiary institutions and the Cardano ecosystem

We built formal partnerships with institutions like the European Business Institute of Luxembourg, Richfield, Inkuba Academy, and worked with students from Tshwane University of Technology, WeThinkCode_, and Nzvedaz Crypto Hub Academy. This is a great start toward getting Cardano formally recognised by academic tertiary institutions and their students.

2.3 Tertiary Students Lack Web3 Skills.

Coxygen Global reached out to such students and introduced them not only to Cardano but also to Plutus and Haskell, with on-chain credentials.

2.4 Weak collaboration across Cardano communities: French developers excluded.

This also strengthened collaboration among Cardano communities by being diverse and inclusive, leading to effective cooperation with French Cardano communities, which had previously

lacked access to this type of training. The same applies to the Inkuba Academy partnership and collaboration.

2.5 Cardano products and services limited market

By exposing hundreds of students to Cardano tools and opportunities early in their careers, we built a pipeline of future users, promoters, and builders who are now familiar with the ecosystem.

2.6 Small Cardano developer and talent base

Established a student developer base for Cardano in Plutus Haskell.

2.7 Promotion of CIP-1694, Midnight, and Hydra

Exposed and applied interested students to these emerging Cardano technologies.

2.8 Long-term sustainability of blockchain education initiatives

Through embedded engagement in universities and colleges such as Victory Youth Group, Richfield, and TUT, we are building enduring institutional relationships globally.

2.9 Project KPIs: What We Delivered

No	KPI	Target	Achievement	% of Target
1	Universities	16	47	294%
2	Students Enrolled	240	630	263%
3	On-Chain Credentials	240	3100	1,292%
4	Training Videos	4	20	500%
5	Feedback Surveys	4	4	100%

No	Project KPI	Target	Achievement
1	**Universities reached**	16 universities/colleges	Students enrolled or trained from 47 universities/colleges; formal collaborations with key institutions established.
2	**Students reached**	240 tertiary students	630 enrolled and over 400 trained by March 2026.
3	**On-chain credentials**	240 credentials for trained students	3,100 on-chain credentials minted by March 2026.
4	**Training model**	Effective student support delivery	20 facilitators employed and operating daily across 3 time zones.
5	**Training videos**	At least 1 per milestone	20 video sessions produced.
6	**Marketing materials**	Brochures/videos	Multiple brochures and branded merchandise (caps and t-shirts) created.
7	**Student GitHub accounts**	List maintained	Comprehensive list of student repositories maintained.
8	**Feedback surveys**	At least 1 per milestone	4 surveys and feedback reports conducted.
9	**Training materials**	Haskell, Plutus	Training materials developed, translated (e.g., into French), and improved. A dedicated Dapp was created, allowing students to train and mint on-chain credentials.

Figure 1: Project KPIs details

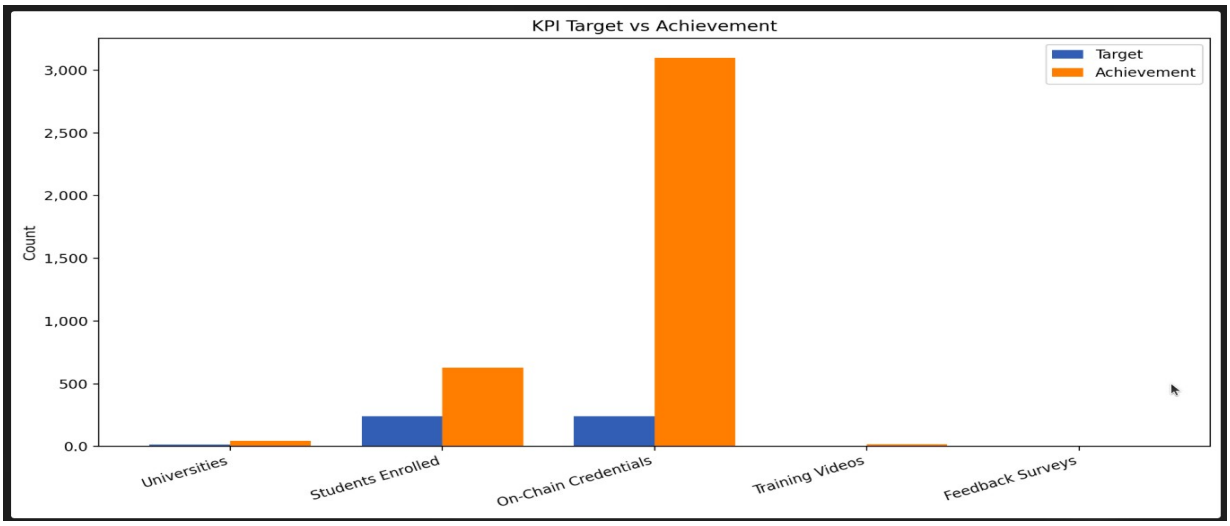

Figure 2: KPIs

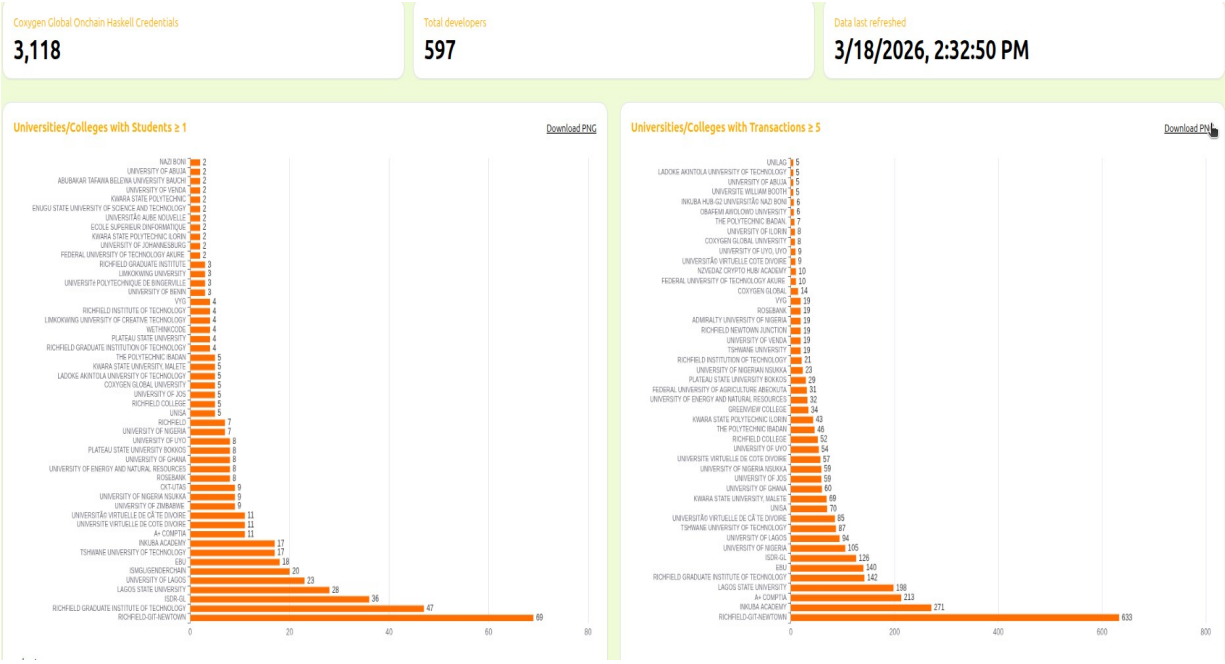

Figure 3: Students Universities and Colleges 48 : https://coxygen.co/universities/reports.php

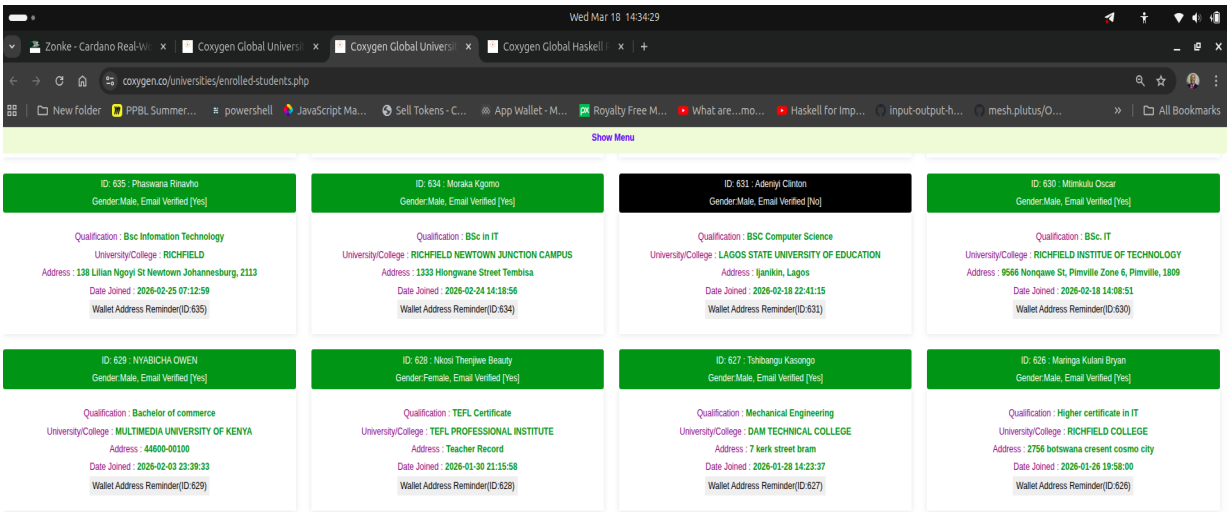

Figure 4: Enrollement 635

3 Key achievements (in particular around collaboration and engagement)

3.1 Strategic Academic Partnerships

The project built collaborations that supported recruitment, training, and formal learning pathways:

- European Business Institute (Luxembourg) – Partnered on further Plutus Haskell training (CP108). **123 students were supported across 3 phases: 41, 47, and 35.**
- Richfield – Collaborated on student participation and engagement. And has the largest consistent student enrollment.
- Tshwane University of Technology (TUT) – Students participated through Work Integrated Learning and **Industry Experience(IE).**
- **WeThinkCode, Inkuba Academy, Nzvedaz Crypto Hub Academy, Victory Youth Group** – have some of their students joining this project. These are well established institutions.

3.2 Cross-Project Ecosystem Collaboration

With Intersect MBO Open Source, our students have taken part in forth nightly Developer Advocate sessions. They have also been working with other Cardano tools like Helios.

3.3 On-Chain Credential Innovation

Students earned Cardano on-chain credentials as proof of Plutus Haskell Learning. By March 2026, they had minted over 3,100 on-chain credentials, creating a transparent and verifiable record of progress in Cardano.

3.4 Facilitator Network Development

The project built a live support model with over 20 facilitators operating daily across 3 time zones. This helped most students not only knew to Cardano but also knew to blockchain coding.

3.5 Geographic Reach

The project was mostly active across 6 countries: **South Africa, Nigeria, DRC, Burkina Faso, Ivory Coast, and Ghana.**

3.6 Marketing and Brand Presence

The project also developed marketing materials and branded merchandise to strengthen visibility and community identity.

Figure 5: Marketing, Recruiting and Promotion

4 Key learnings

4.1 Institutional Engagement Requires Patience

Governance and approval processes can delay collaboration, especially in formal institutional environments. This slowed some partnerships and required patience and follow-up.

4.2 Self-Paced Learning is better for Part Time Students in Haskell

Remote training was affected by student college workload, limited resources, assignments, homework, exams, and holidays. This has led to lots of changes and improvements like : Live facilitation, email tutorials, in-person training and regular support.

4.3 Wallet Onboarding was a major problem

Students struggled with Cardano wallet learning and setup. This led to the creation of Coxy Wallet, a cross-platform solution designed to reduce the onboarding barrier.

4.4 Hardware Limitations Require Creative Solutions

Existing tools were not flexible enough for many students. demeter.run closed workspaces, Kuber IDE is up to now not flexible enough, and Linux-based Nix installation was and still is complicated for Windows developers. This has showed the need for a lighter and more accessible development environment: **Plutus Playground Studio.(We are building this via Zonke bounty platform).**

4.5 Introduced facilitators in training

A structured support model with 20 facilitators across 3 time zones helped improve participation, consistency, and student progress. This **met with tudent college workload, limited resources, assignments, homework, exams, and holidays.** In 2026 going forward we have upgraded this to include email tutorials.

5 Next steps for the product or service developed

5.1 Improve training delivery

Improve training through email-based support, better self-paced tutorials, and introduce live in-person training.

5.2 a) Develop Lightweight Development Environment

Develop a Plutus Playground Studio to reduce technical barriers. This is needed because demeter.run closed workspaces, Kuber IDE is not flexible enough, and Linux/Nix setup is difficult for Windows developers.

5.3 b) Plutus Haskell Students Jobs - Zonke

Develop RWA on Cardano via the Zonke Job platform, creating a path from training into practical work opportunities.

5.4 Expand Institutional Footprint

Continue building partnerships with more universities, colleges, and training institutions.

5.5 Enhance Facilitator Program

Strengthen the facilitator model that supports students daily across multiple time zones.

5.6 Pursue Follow-on Funding

Seek further funding to scale the programme, improve tools, and expand delivery.

5.7 Add in-person training

Introduce in-person training sessions to complement remote learning.

6 Final thoughts/comments

This project showed that long-term, facilitator-led engagement works better than short workshops for teaching Cardano development. By March 2026, the project had enrolled 630 students, trained over 400, reached students from 47 universities/ colleges, and enabled them to mint over 3,100 on-chain credentials.

The project also built strong collaboration across academic and community partners, supported by over 20 facilitators across 3 time zones, and expanded activity across 6 countries. Key barriers such as governance delays, student workload, wallet onboarding, and technical setup challenges helped shape practical solutions like Coxy Wallet, stronger facilitation, better training support, and plans for a Plutus Playground Studio.

Overall, the project created a stronger foundation for onboarding the next generation of Cardano developers. We highly thank Catalyst, Voters, collaborators, partners and students to have this project reach this stage.

We will seek further funding, create more partnerships, and in 2026 going forward we are focusing more on Cardano Real World Application coding via the newly created Dapp **Zonke** bounty platform((https://coxygen.co/universities/zonke/index.php)).

7 Links to other relevant project sources or documents

7.1 Main Project Links

(a) GitHub Repository: https://github.com/wimsio/universities

(b) Project Website: https://coxygen.co/universities

(c) Project Wiki: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/wiki

(d) Interactive Tutorials: https://coxygen.co/universities/interactive-email-tutorials-english/index.html?lesson=video1

Evidence (December 2025)

(e) On-Chain Credentials (2,932): https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/dec%202025/onchain-tracking/Nov%20Dec%202025%20Progress%20Tokens2.pdf

(f) Transaction Evidence: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/dec%202025/onchain-tracking/Transactions%20By%20Students%202025.pdf

(g) Student GitHub Accounts: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/dec%202025/students-github-accounts.md

(h) Main Register: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/dec%202025/reports/Main%20Register%20Nov%202025.pdf

(i) Training Videos List: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/dec%202025/training-videos.md

(j) Marketing Materials: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/dec%202025/marketing-tshirts-caps.md

(k) Survey Report: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/dec%202025/survey-report-30-12-2025.md

Evidence (October 2025)

(l) 68 Students with 837 Progress Tokens: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/october%202025/68%20Students%20Milestone%202%20Total%20Progress%20Tokens%20837%20Nov%203%202025.pdf

(m) September Register: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/october%202025/Main%20September%20Register%202025.pdf

(n) October Feedback Report: https://github.com/wimsio/universities/blob/main/reports-classes-attendance/october%202025/October%202025%20Feedback%20Report.md

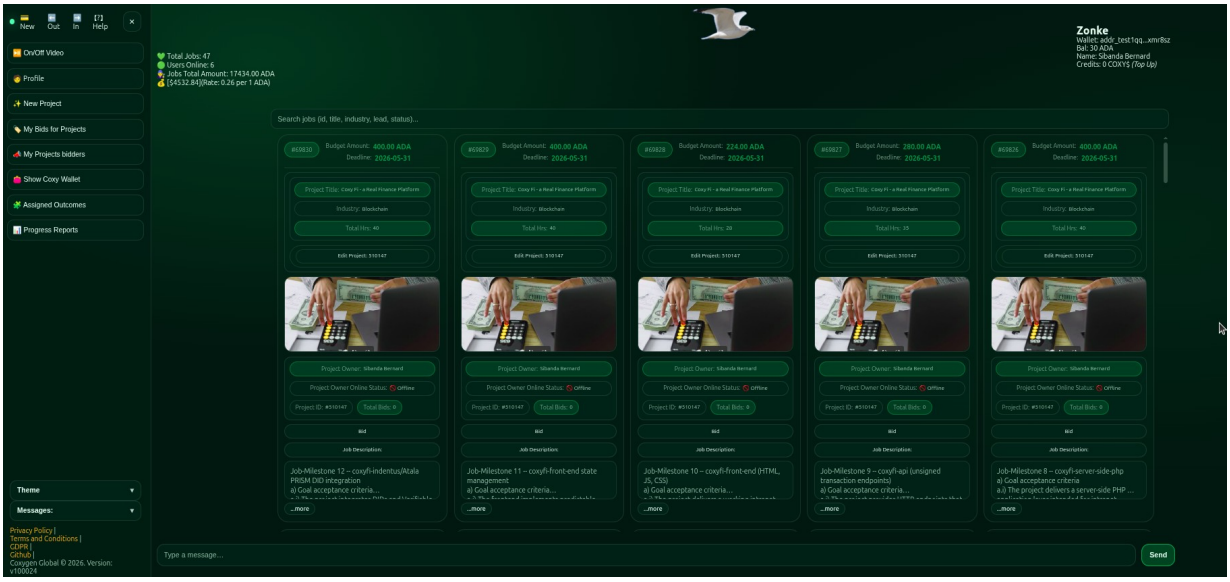

Figure 6: Zonk RWA Bounty Platform

By Mr B Sibanda (CTO)

15-03-2026